



such as D-Link and CMV have jumped on the bandwagon to earn an extra buck—other brands such as Sony and Acer have even pulled out of the CRT segment and started concentrating only on LCDs.

Warranty is a major issue for monitors, and most vendors do provide carry-in warranty to the nearest location. Quite a few vendors provide a 3-year warranty on all available sizes. As LCD is a new technology, it demands more in terms of warranty—even a single pixel going out of synch could cause users to return their prized possessions. But industry sources mention that the standard convention is that if there are more than six bad pixels, the LCD

needs to be replaced.

Today, entry-level LCD monitors are available for Rs 18,000 and upwards. This is a stark contrast from the starting price of Rs 25,000, last year. Sharp has the widest product range, with around 17 monitors catering to all kinds of users. Right from first-time buyers (Rs 24,000 and up) to the rich and famous (Rs 1,00,000 plus). A lot of vendors from Taiwan and China are also making an appearance in India. The next couple of months might see some major changes in entry-level monitors, such as a shift from 15-inch to 17-inch; home users may even venture into the LCD market in a big way.



highest resolution available depends on the highest resolution that the PC's video card is capable of producing.

Controls

■ Take a look at the controls on the monitor. Every monitor allows you to adjust the screen image, brightness and colours. Three types of controls are available—analogue, digital and on-screen digital. Economy monitors offer analogue controls in the form of knobs or dials on the monitor case. Digital controls are microprocessor-based and more precise. Adjustments to monitor settings made with digital controls are saved when you turn the power off. On-screen digital controls allow adjusting the monitor with just a few controls and menu options which appear on the screen.

Older monitors only have brightness and contrast controls. New monitors have additional controls that can control the size and position of the display. The latest monitors allow for the adjustment of advanced features, such as colour convergence, vertical centering, vertical size, pincushion correction and many other adjustments. All CRT monitors have a degaussing circuit which zaps

away colour swirls produced by random (or the earth's) magnetic fields.

Features

Some monitors offer BNC connectors for red, green and blue signals, besides the standard 15-pin HDD VGA connector. Typically, monitors using these BNC connectors provide a sharper image. These BNC connectors will connect to a standard VGA connector via a special cable. This is usually included with the monitor, as no special video card is required.

Looks

■ Check out the focus and clarity of a monitor before you buy, as the clarity of monitors varies between brands. The only way to tell just how well a monitor will look is to physically see it yourself. So if possible, view the monitor while using the computer at several different resolutions. Remember, a good monitor will have a low Dot Pitch (.28 or smaller) and a high refresh rate (72 KHz or higher).

Anti-Glare Coating

■ Anti-glare coating on monitor screens makes images clearer. This anti-glare is obtained by spraying the monitor screen

with silica coating, which reflects light at different angles to eliminate glare. Older monitors often do not have this coating.

Warranty

Be sure to check out the monitor's warranty as the warranty can vary from 1 to 3 years. Some manufacturers offer on-site warranty, which means you don't have to ship your monitor or carry it into a service centre. With some monitors requiring two adults to lift them, an on-site warranty might prove handy. Also ask about where to get your monitor repaired when it is out of warranty.

Safety and Energy Ratings

Many monitors conform to a variety of power saving and low emission (electromagnetic) standards. A monitor conforming to MPR II guidelines states that it is within a set standard for electromagnetic energy emissions, which some studies have linked to health problems. Even stricter than MPR II guidelines are TCO guidelines. A FCC Class B rating states that the monitor conforms to a reduced amount of interference to nearby TV and radio reception. Consult the monitor's documentation for details.

Keep your eyes smiling even after hours of working.



15
500G



17
700S



19
900B



LG Colour Monitors

Eye care in cyber age.